

Supplementary Materials for ‘Blame as Sensemaking: A Computational Mapping of Target Framings Across Online AI Discourse’

Somin Lee

gracesomin@kaist.ac.kr

School of Digital Humanities and Computational Social Sciences

KAIST

Daejeon, Republic of Korea

A Classification Materials

A.1 Zero-shot Prompt and Labels for Negative Reaction Detection

Component	Description
Hypothesis	The text is expressing a {} evaluation, vision, attitude, or emotion toward its topic.
Label: negative	The text expresses a negative evaluation, vision, attitude, or emotion toward its topic.
Label: positive_or_neutral	The text expresses a positive, neutral, or non-negative evaluation, vision, attitude, or emotion toward its topic.

A.2 Few-shot Prompt for Target Classification and Blame Detection

Instruction. You are an expert annotator. Your task is to identify:

- (1) which entity categories are the targets of negative evaluation, and
- (2) whether the text assigns blame to any of those targets.

The text has **already been confirmed to contain a negative evaluation**. Do **not** evaluate sentiment. Only identify target(s) and blame.

A.2.1 Stage 1: Target Identification. A **target** is any entity that the text portrays as:

- doing something,
- failing to do something,
- making a decision,
- causing an effect,
- behaving irresponsibly,
- acting incompetently,
- influencing outcomes,
- being the actor behind a negative situation,
- generally causing a negative reaction without explicit action, or
- being a potential agent of future harm.

Targets must be the entity receiving a negative reaction based on their **action, inaction, intention, behavior, or responsibility**. Mere mention of an entity is **not sufficient**.

AI models may be treated as actors if the text describes them as acting (e.g., “ChatGPT keeps messing things up”). Anthropomorphism is acceptable.

Target Category Definitions.

- **ai**: Specific AI models or systems (e.g., ChatGPT, Grok, “AI”, “LLMs”).
- **ai_comp**: Companies or labs that build AI models (e.g., OpenAI, xAI, Anthropic).
- **other_comp**: Platforms or companies involved in deployment, moderation, or platform governance rather than model development (e.g., Google, Microsoft).
- **ai_dev**: Individual or loosely defined groups of engineers, developers, researchers, or executives (e.g., Sam Altman, Elon Musk, “the devs”).
- **society**: Institutional or structural actors such as boards, policymakers, regulators, Big Tech as a collective, the media, the industry, or governing bodies shaping the AI ecosystem.
- **users**: AI users, online communities, Reddit users, “people here”, “haters”.
- **none**: No actionable entity is assigned responsibility or behavior.

Multiple targets may be marked as **1** if applicable.

Special Rule for Companies such as Google or Microsoft. Classification depends on the role criticized in the text:

- Criticism of building, training, or designing AI models → **ai_comp**
- Criticism of deployment, platform behavior, policy, moderation, or corporate/systemic decisions → **other_comp**

Use only the role assigned *in the text*. Do not rely on real-world assumptions.

A.2.2 Stage 2: Blame Detection. Blame is marked as **1** *only if all* of the following conditions are met:

- (1) The target’s behavior, decision, or failure is described as problematic, harmful, incompetent, negligent, unethical, dangerous, or producing negative effects.
- (2) An explicit or implicit **causal link** is established between the target’s action or inaction and a negative outcome, including speculative or potential outcomes.
- (3) Responsibility is assigned to the target through recognition of the target’s action.

Examples of Implicit Blame.

- “They caused this mess.”
- “The board rushed this.”
- “ChatGPT keeps making things worse.”
- “The devs clearly didn’t think through the consequences.”

Blame is marked as **0** when:

- No causality is stated or implied,
- The target is criticized but not linked to a negative outcome,
- Responsibility is not assigned, or
- A problem is described without an identifiable actor.

A.2.3 Output Format. Return **only** the following JSON object:

```
{
  "targets": {
    "ai": 0/1,
    "ai_comp": 0/1,
    "other_comp": 0/1,
    "ai_dev": 0/1,
    "society": 0/1,
    "users": 0/1,
    "none": 0/1
  },
  "blame": 0/1
}
```

No commentary. No sentiment analysis. No references to external documents.

A.2.4 Few-Shot Examples.

Example 1. Text: “How about we stop wasting good technology on gimmicks, and do something useful for a change?”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":0, "ai_comp":0, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":0, "users":0, "none":1},
  "blame": 0
}
```

Example 2. Text: “Gemini is easily the worst AI assistant out right now. I mean this is beyond embarrassing.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":1, "ai_comp":0, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 0
}
```

Example 3. Text: “Trying to learn German and was gaslit by an AI.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":1, "ai_comp":0, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```

Example 4. Text: “ChatGPT is using non encrypted inputs. Your personal life is exposed to OpenAI developers and researchers; your data is analyzed, traded, and shared.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":0, "ai_comp":1, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```

Example 5. Text: “Ilya Sutskever, Greg Brockman, Sam Altman & Elon Musk were concerned that DeepMind’s Demis Hassabis could create an AGI dictatorship.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":0, "ai_comp":0, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":1, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```

Example 6. Text: “There isn’t a government or corporation anywhere in the world with enough integrity to develop AI and not abuse it terribly. We are creating the most powerful victims in our history. How is this anything but the final goal of colonialism? ... What do you think AI would say about this if we weren’t preventing it from saying stuff about this?”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":0, "ai_comp":0, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":1, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```

Example 7. Text: “Google employees reportedly begged it not to release ‘pathological liar’ AI chatbot Bard.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":1, "ai_comp":1, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":0, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```

Example 8. Text: “Sam Altman was accused of being shady about OpenAI’s safety efforts, and the company allegedly silenced employees.”

```
{
  "targets": { "ai":0, "ai_comp":1, "other_comp":0, "ai_dev":1, "society":0, "users":0, "none":0},
  "blame": 1
}
```